Commodities Sentiment Report

2026-07-07 12:26 UTC

Previous edition: 2026-07-07 11:10 UTC. First edition using the expanded source registry (independent Fable source map): adds COT/positioning notes (Saxo/Hansen), Kitco's quantified gold survey, SMM China physical-market data, US Drought Monitor, and ApeWisdom Reddit gauges. Three measurements changed on the new data.

COMMODITY	SENTIMENT	CROWD	Δ VS LAST	ONE-LINE DRIVER
Crude Oil (WTI/Brent)	**-1 Leaning bearish**	○○○ 0	unchanged	Third day of gains toward $69 vs OPEC+ barrels; Trump pressuring pump prices lower
Natural Gas	**-2 Bearish**	○○○ 0	unchanged	Monday's heat-demand pop fades against confirmed cooler forecasts through Jul 15
Gold	**+1 Leaning bullish**	●●○ 2	crowd ▲ from 1	Kitco survey quantifies the consensus: Wall St 69% / Main St 54% bullish
Silver	**+2 Bullish**	●●○ 2	crowd ▼ from 3	WSB is split (58/42) where StockTwits is uniform — crowd risk real but tempered
Copper	**+2 Bullish**	●○○ 1	▲ from Leaning bullish	TC/RC at $0, concentrate port stocks at historic lows — structural deficit signals
Wheat	**+2 Bullish**	●○○ 1	unchanged	63% of winter wheat in drought (vs 15% last yr); smallest crop since 1965/66
Corn	**+2 Bullish**	●○○ 1	unchanged	Dec corn firm overnight; France damage + China framework intact
Soybeans	**+1 Leaning bullish**	●○○ 1	crowd ▲ from 0	More China buying (5-cargo rumor on top of Cofco); crop progress ahead of normal caps it

Direction: −3 Very bearish → +3 Very bullish. Crowd: 0 two-sided → 3 crowded & uniform (contrarian risk). Sentiment reflects the tone of current news and trader coverage about the price outlook, not the last price move.

BIGGEST SHIFTS

The expanded sources moved three readings. **Copper upgraded to Bullish (+2)**: SMM and IEA data show China copper concentrate port inventories plunging to historic lows and the annual TC/RC smelting benchmark settled at **$0/tonne — the lowest ever** — classic structural-deficit signals, with Chinese apparent consumption +9% y/y and institutional positioning net long. That flips the **gold−copper pair negative (-1)** for the first time in the history — news flow now favors the growth leg over the rate leg. **Silver's crowd score was trimmed 3 → 2**: ApeWisdom shows WallStreetBets genuinely split on SLV (58% positive / 42% negative across 45 mentions) where StockTwits is uniformly bullish — crowded, but with more two-way flow than yesterday's read implied. Gold's crowd firmed 1 → 2 on Kitco's quantified survey (69% of Wall Street analysts, 54% of retail bullish).

RV pair matrix

Sentiment spread = leg1 − leg2; positive favors leg1 outperformance.

PAIR	SPREAD	Δ VS LAST	READ
gold − silver	-1	unchanged	Still favors silver beta; crowd gap narrowed (2 vs 2), so the ratio trade is less about positioning risk than it was yesterday
corn − soybeans	+1	unchanged	Beans keep collecting China cargoes but ahead-of-normal crop progress caps the leg; spread stable pending Thursday's export sales
corn − wheat	0	unchanged	Wheat's drought stats (63% of winter wheat area) vs corn's demand+weather mix — still different engines, same score
crude − natgas	+1	unchanged	Crude grinding higher into Wednesday's EIA while gas fights confirmed cool forecasts; the spread remains the war-risk expression
gold − copper	**-1**	**▼ from 0**	**Flipped.** Copper's structural-deficit signals broke the tie with gold's rate story — first divergence inside the metals complex this week

Catalyst calendar (next 7 days)

DATE	EVENT	LEGS	WHY IT MATTERS NOW
Tue Jul 7	API petroleum inventories (4:30pm ET)	crude	First stocks read since OPEC+ quota hike and Aramco OSP cut
Wed Jul 8	FOMC minutes (2pm ET, confirmed)	gold, silver, copper	The repricing gate; hawkish minutes test gold's 69/54 bullish consensus and silver's crowd
Wed Jul 8	EIA Weekly Petroleum Status (10:30am ET)	crude	Draw = floor at $68-70 holds; build = glut narrative re-accelerates
Thu Jul 9	EIA natural gas storage (10:30am ET)	natural-gas	Another >90 Bcf injection entrenches -2 against the crowd's fade thesis
Thu Jul 9	USDA weekly export sales (8:30am ET)	soybeans, corn, wheat	Cofco cargoes + the 5-cargo rumor should start printing; the beans upgrade lives or dies here
Thu Jul 9	US Drought Monitor update (droughtmonitor.unl.edu)	wheat, corn	Plains drought footprint vs the 63%-in-drought baseline
Fri Jul 10	CFTC COT (3:30pm ET) + Saxo/Hansen weekly COT note	all	Wheat short-covering check; copper managed-money length vs the new deficit narrative
Fri Jul 10	Kitco Weekly Gold Survey	gold	Week-over-week shift in the 69/54 bullish consensus
Jul 10-12 window	USDA WASDE	wheat, corn, soybeans	First full balance sheet since the acreage shocks
Mon Jul 13	USDA Crop Progress (4pm ET)	corn, soybeans	Pollination conditions; beans currently running ahead of normal (34% blooming)

Score history (oldest → newest)

crude-oil

-2 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1

natural-gas

-1 → -1 → -1 → -2 → -2 → -2

gold		+1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1
silver		+1 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2
copper		0 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +2
wheat		+2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2
corn		+1 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2
soybeans		-1 → 0 → 0 → 0 → +1 → +1

Crude Oil (WTI / Brent) **-1 Leaning bearish** ○○○ **0**

What's happening. WTI extended gains a third day toward $69 (Brent ~$72.35) even while hovering near four-month lows, as the market weighs recovering Hormuz traffic and OPEC+ quota increases against residual war risk; Washington adds a new bearish-flavored wrinkle with Trump publicly demanding $2.25-2.50/gal gasoline (FXStreet, OilPrice, Investing.com).

Social pulse. TradingView chatter still sell-skewed at the $68-70 zone; USO barely registers on Reddit trackers — no retail crowding either way.

Positioning read. Three up-days against a bearish narrative is short- covering behavior, not a trend change — the two-sided read (crowd 0) holds. Political pressure on pump prices is a new soft cap on rallies worth noting for the demand-season narrative. API tonight, EIA tomorrow.

Natural Gas **-2 Bearish** ○○○ **0**

What's happening. August gas settled +1.53% Monday on heat-driven power-burn speculation, but the Commodity Weather Group reconfirmed cooler forecasts for the eastern half of the US through July 15, and the structural bear case (storage +6.2% vs average, ~110 Bcf/d production) is intact (Barchart via Investing.com, NGI).

Social pulse. Trader polls still lean bullish against the news; UNG has zero Reddit mentions — retail is simply absent from this leg.

Positioning read. Monday's bounce is what the crowd's "priced-in" thesis looks like when it gets a warm afternoon — it doesn't survive a cool forecast run plus a big Thursday injection. Fresh shorts still have poor risk/reward down here; the trade remains reactive to forecast flips.

Gold **+1 Leaning bullish** ●●○ **2**

What's happening. Gold holds the $4,140-4,166 consolidation into Wednesday's FOMC minutes (2pm ET confirmed). The new quantified crowd data: Kitco's weekly survey has 69% of Wall Street analysts and 54% of Main Street bullish for this week — a solid but not extreme consensus (Kitco survey, Trading Economics).

Social pulse. GLD on WSB: only 8 mentions but 80% positive — low retail attention, quietly bullish (ApeWisdom GLD).

Positioning read. Crowd firmed to 2 on the survey data — the consensus is real now, which trims the "uncrowded way to hold the view" edge gold had over silver yesterday (silver's crowd came down simultaneously). Into the minutes the complex is uniformly long-biased; the pair trade matters less, sizing matters more.

Silver **+2 Bullish** ●●○ 2

What's happening. Silver consolidates around $61-62 after the ~6% run, still underpinned by the rate repricing (Trading Economics, Kitco).

Social pulse. *The Reddit tracker tempered yesterday's read:* SLV is WSB's most-mentioned metal (45 mentions, 32 users) but sentiment is split 58% / 42% — with "calls AND puts" among top keywords — where StockTwits remains uniformly bullish (ApeWisdom SLV).

Positioning read. Crowd trimmed 3 → 2: the retail base is bigger but more two-sided than the StockTwits-only view suggested — an air pocket on hawkish minutes is still the risk, but there's real two-way flow to absorb it. The +2 direction stands on unchanged fundamentals.

Copper **+2 Bullish** ●○○ 1

What's happening. *Upgraded.* The expanded China sweep surfaced a structural story the generic queries missed: copper concentrate port inventories in China are plunging to historic lows, the annual TC/RC smelting benchmark settled at **$0/tonne — the lowest ever** — and Chinese apparent consumption ran +9% y/y with supply-chain destocking (IEA, SMM, Mysteel). Price still trades a narrow $6.15-6.25 range.

Social pulse. Institutional net-long positioning noted in trader commentary, with copper-vs-gold outperformance theses circulating (TradingView); CPER has zero Reddit mentions — no retail crowd at all (crowd 1).

Positioning read. The bull case graduated from macro-tailwind to structural: zero smelting margins and vanishing concentrate stocks are the kind of physical evidence that outlasts a Fed print. Price hasn't moved yet — that's the point: a +2 narrative in a flat price with no retail crowding is the setup RV desks look for. Watch the Yangshan premium (SMM publishes daily) as the confirmation gauge; the gold−copper spread flip is the expression.

Wheat **+2 Bullish** ●○○ 1

What's happening. KC HRW firm (+3.5¢ to ~$6.39) while Chicago dipped 0.7% — the intra-wheat spread itself reflects where the damage is. The Drought Monitor data quantifies the story: **63% of US winter wheat production area is in drought vs 15% a year ago**, and winter wheat production is forecast down 27% y/y at 1,030M bu, the lowest since 1965/66 (USDA weather bulletin, Farm Progress).

Social pulse. Managed money still described as extremely short against bullish polls — the squeeze setup is unchanged.

Positioning read. The drought quantification hardens the asymmetry; KC over Chicago is the sharper expression of the HRW story. Friday's COT plus Thursday's Drought Monitor update are the dated tells. Black Sea offers remain the invalidator.

Corn **+2 Bullish** ●○○ 1

What's happening. Dec corn firmed overnight (+2.25¢ to ~$4.45 after Wednesday's +6.25¢), holding the one-month-high zone on the France damage and China-framework mix (Farm Progress, Barchart).

Social pulse. Still lagging; CORN/WEAT/SOYB ETFs barely register on Reddit trackers — ag legs carry no retail crowd.

Positioning read. Unchanged: the +2 rides on weather plus the framework; Monday's Crop Progress is the dated risk. The corn−soybean spread is the fade vehicle if pollination forecasts turn benign.

Soybeans **+1 Leaning bullish** ●○○ 1

What's happening. The China bid keeps building: on top of Cofco's 6+ cargoes, rumors of another ~5 cargoes bought surfaced late in the day, with sellers staying back. The cap: crop progress is running ahead of normal (34% blooming, +6 pts; 9% setting pods) — a yield-friendly signal (Farm Progress, Trading Economics).

Social pulse. Chatter is waking up to the China story (crowd 0 → 1); SOYB itself has no meaningful Reddit presence.

Positioning read. Demand is confirming faster than expected — Thursday's export sales print (plus any USDA daily flash sales ≥100kt, worth checking each morning) is the moment this either becomes a +2 story or stalls. The ahead-of-normal crop is the reason to keep the upgrade measured: supply is cooperating too.
